

SquareUp — Participant Privacy Notice

Effective date: May 21, 2026

The short version. SquareUp runs research interviews using an AI voice agent. Before you take part, here is what matters most:

You will be speaking with an **AI interviewer**, not a human.

Your interview is **recorded** (audio) and turned into a written transcript so your answers can be analysed.

Taking part is **voluntary** — you can decline, skip any question, or stop at any time.

Your answers are usually shared with the **brand or organisation that commissioned the research**.

Interviews are for **adults aged 18 and over** only.

We do **not sell** your personal data and do **not use it for advertising**.

You have privacy **rights** (see Section 9) and can contact us any time at hello@joinsquareup.com.

1. About this notice

This Participant Privacy Notice explains how SquareUp ("SquareUp," "we," "us," or "our") collects and uses the personal data of people who take part in our research interviews ("Participants," "you"). "Personal data" means information that identifies or relates to you.

If you are interacting with SquareUp's website, or you are a SquareUp business contact rather than a research Participant, the Website Privacy Policy (Document 1) applies to you instead.

2. Our role: who decides how your data is used

SquareUp conducts interviews in two kinds of engagement, and our role — and yours — differs slightly between them:

- **Interviews commissioned by a brand.** Often a brand or organisation (the "Research Organisation") hires SquareUp to interview people. In these engagements the Research Organisation decides the purpose of the research and is the controller of your personal data, and SquareUp acts as its service provider / processor. The Research Organisation's own privacy notice may also apply, and will be made available to you where required.
- **Interviews run by SquareUp.** Sometimes SquareUp recruits Participants and conducts research on its own account. In these engagements SquareUp is the controller of your personal data, and this notice governs how it is used.

In both cases, SquareUp handles your personal data as described in this notice and protects it with the same safeguards.

3. You are speaking with an AI

Your interview is conducted by an artificial-intelligence voice agent, not a human interviewer. The AI agent will tell you this at the start of the interview. It asks questions, listens to your answers, and may ask natural follow-up questions. A summary of your responses — and sometimes the recording or transcript — may later be reviewed by people at SquareUp or the Research Organisation.

The AI may also **automatically decide whether you are eligible** for a particular study, based on your answers to short screening questions. This screening only affects whether you take part in the research; it does not produce any legal or similarly significant effect on you. If you have a question about it, you can reach a person at SquareUp using the details in Section 14.

4. The personal data we collect

- **Interview data** — the audio recording of your interview, the written transcript, and the responses and information you choose to share during the interview.
- **Contact and scheduling data** — your name, phone number or email, and similar details, so we can invite you, schedule the interview, and connect the call. In brand-commissioned engagements, this is usually provided to us by the Research Organisation.
- **Screening data** — your answers to any short screening questions used to confirm you are eligible for a study.
- **Technical data** — information such as IP address, device, and connection details, collected to deliver the interview and keep it secure.
- **Incentive and payment data** — if you are offered an incentive for taking part, the information needed to pay it, such as your name and payment or tax details. Incentives are not offered for every study, and in some studies the Research Organisation, not SquareUp, pays them.

Please share only what you are comfortable sharing. You do not need to provide sensitive information (such as health details) unless the study specifically asks for it and you choose to.

5. How interviews happen, and recording

Depending on the study, the AI agent may call you (an outbound call), or you may start the interview yourself by clicking a link or dialling in at a time that suits you (an inbound or participant-initiated session).

Every interview is recorded. Before recording begins, the AI agent will tell you that the interview will be recorded and will ask for your consent. **If you do not consent, the interview will not proceed.** You can stop the interview, or ask to withdraw, at any time — see Section 9. We record and transcribe your interview to capture your answers; we do **not** create a voiceprint of you and do **not** use voice-biometric identification.

If we contacted you by phone for an outbound interview, we did so on the basis that the Research Organisation or SquareUp had a lawful basis, and any required consent, to call you. If you would prefer not to be contacted again, tell the AI agent or email hello@joinsquareup.com.

6. Why we use your personal data

- **To conduct the research** — to carry out the interview, create the recording and transcript, and analyse and synthesise responses into insights.
- **To deliver insights to the Research Organisation** — in brand-commissioned engagements, to share your responses and the resulting insights with the organisation that commissioned the study.
- **To pay incentives** — where an incentive applies and SquareUp is paying it.
- **To keep the service secure** and to prevent fraud and misuse.
- **To comply with law** and respond to lawful requests.
- **To improve our service** — we may use interview data to improve our platform and AI, but **only in de-identified or aggregated form** that does not identify you. We do not use identifiable recordings or transcripts to train our AI models.

Where the law requires a legal basis, we rely on your consent — for example, to record the interview and to collect your responses — and, where applicable, the legitimate interests of SquareUp or the Research Organisation in conducting research. You can withdraw consent at any time, which will stop further processing of your data going forward.

7. How we share your personal data

- **The Research Organisation** — in brand-commissioned engagements, your responses, recording, transcript, and the resulting insights are shared with the organisation that commissioned the study. It is required to protect your data and use it only for the research purpose.
- **Service providers and sub-processors** — vendors that help us run interviews and our platform, such as voice-infrastructure, transcription, AI / large-language-model, cloud-hosting, and security providers. They may use your data only to provide services to us. The current list is in the DPA (Document 4).
- **Legal and safety** — authorities or others where we believe disclosure is required by law, or necessary to protect rights, property, or safety.
- **Corporate transactions** — a successor in a merger, acquisition, or similar transaction, subject to this notice.

We do **not** sell your personal data, and we do **not** use or share it for targeted or cross-context advertising.

8. Where your data is stored, and how long we keep it

SquareUp follows a data-localisation approach: if you are in the United States, your personal data is stored and processed on servers in the United States; if you are in India, it is stored and processed on servers in India. Some service providers or SquareUp team members may access data across these locations to operate the service; where data moves between countries, we apply appropriate safeguards.

We keep interview recordings and transcripts for approximately **12 months** after the study, unless the Research Organisation asks us to delete them sooner, a different period is agreed, or the law requires otherwise. After that, we delete them or keep only de-identified or

aggregated information. Contact data and incentive records are kept only as long as needed for the study, payment, and legal record-keeping.

9. Your rights and choices

You can decline to take part, skip any question, or stop the interview at any time, with no penalty. Depending on where you live and which laws apply, you may also have the right to:

- **access** the personal data we hold about you and obtain a copy;
- **correct** inaccurate or incomplete data;
- **delete** your personal data;
- **withdraw consent** to recording or to further use of your data;
- **object to or restrict** certain processing; and
- **complain** to a regulator and, where the law provides, **appeal** our decision on your request.

To exercise any of these rights, email hello@joinsquareup.com. We will verify your identity and respond within the time the law requires. In brand-commissioned engagements, if your request concerns data controlled by the Research Organisation, we may pass your request to them and assist in handling it.

If you are in India, the DPDP Act also gives you the right to nominate another person to exercise your rights, and to use SquareUp's grievance-redressal process (Section 14) before approaching the Data Protection Board of India.

10. Sensitive information

SquareUp does not seek to collect sensitive personal data, and we design studies to avoid it. Some research topics — for example, health, wellness, or personal-care studies — may still lead you to share sensitive information, and a small number of studies may genuinely need it. Share sensitive information only if you are comfortable doing so. Where a study involves sensitive personal data, we collect it only where necessary for that study, we and the Research Organisation obtain any additional consent the law requires, and we apply extra care to protect it.

11. Children

SquareUp's interviews are intended for adults aged 18 and over. We do not knowingly interview, or collect personal data from, anyone under 18. If you are under 18, please do not take part. If you believe we have collected data from someone under 18, contact us at hello@joinsquareup.com and we will delete it.

12. Security

We use administrative, technical, and physical safeguards — including encryption in transit, access controls, and monitoring — to protect your personal data. No system is completely secure, but we work continuously to keep your data safe.

13. Changes to this notice

We may update this notice from time to time. If we make material changes that affect how we handle your personal data, we will update the effective date and, where the law requires, seek your consent again.

14. How to contact us

- **Privacy contact:** Param Jain — hello@joinsquareup.com
- **Entity:** SquareUp, Inc. (Delaware, USA) and its Indian subsidiary. Offices: Entrepreneurs First, 501 Folsom St, San Francisco, CA 94105, USA; and Entrepreneurs First, 4th Floor, UrbanVault65, 11th Main Rd, Sector 6, HSR Layout, Bengaluru, Karnataka 560102, India.
- **Grievance Officer (India, DPDP Act):** Param Jain — param@joinsquareup.com — +91 8668462386

If we cannot resolve your concern, you may contact the data-protection regulator in your jurisdiction, such as the Data Protection Board of India or your US state attorney general.